

Abuse of the Nehemiah. Sabbath, reformed.

16 There dwelt men of Tyre also therein, which brought fish and all manner of ware, and sold on the Sabbath unto the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem.

17 Then I contended with the Nobles of Judah, and sayd vnto them, what euill thing is this that ye doe, and profane the Sabbath day:

18 Did not your fathers thus, and did not our God bring all this euill vpon vs. and vpon this citie: yet ye bring more wrath vpon Israel, by profaning the Sabbath.

19 And it came to passe, that when the gates of Jerusalem beganne to be darke before the Sabbath, I commanded that the gates should be shut, and charged that they should not be opened till after the Sabbath: and some of my seruants set I at the gates, that there should no burden be brought in on the Sabbath day.

20 So the merchants, and sellers of all kinde of ware, lodged without Jerusalem once or twice.

† Heb. b. before the wall.

21 Then I testified against them, and said vnto them, why lodge yee † about the wall: If ye doe so againe, I will lay hands on you. From that time forth came they no more on the Sabbath.

22 And I commanded the Leuites, that they should cleanse themselves, and that they should come and keepe the gates, to sanctifie the Sabbath day: Remember me, O my God, concerning this also, and spare me, according to the greatnesse of thy mercie.

|| Or, multi- tude.

23 ¶ In those dayes also sawe I

Jewes that † had married wiues of Ashdod, of Annon, and of Doab:

† Heb. had made to dwell with them.

24 And their children spake halfe in the speech of Ashdod, and † could not speake in the Jewes language, but according to the language † of ech people.

† Heb. they discerned not to speake.

25 And I contended with them, and || cursed them, and smote certeine of them, and pluckt off their haire, and made them sweare by God, saying, Wee shall not giue your daughters vnto their sonnes, nor take their daughters vnto your sonnes, or for your selues.

† Heb. of people and people. || Or, reuiled them.

26 Did not Solomon king of Israel sinne by these things: yet among many nations was there no king like him, who was beloued of his God, and God made him king ouer all Israel: * neuerthelesse, euen him did outlandish women cause to sinne.

* 1. King. 11 1. &c.

27 Shall wee then hearken vnto you, to doe all this great euill, to transgresse against our God, in marryng strange wiues:

28 And one of the sonnes of Joiada, the sonne of Eliashib the high Priest, was sonne in law to Sanballat the Horonite: therefore I chased him from me.

29 Remember them, O my God, † because they haue defiled the Priesthood, and the couenant of the Priesthood, and of the Leuites.

† Heb. for the defiling.

30 Thus cleansed I them from all strangers, and appointed the wards of the Priests and the Leuites, every one in his businesse:

31 And for the wood-offering, at times appointed, and for the first fruits. Remember me, O my God, for good.

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